

Documentation-backed public edition

FIN Public Handbook

Practical role-based guidance, product value, regulatory boundaries, and trust commitments for current FIN workflows.

Reviewed 17 June 2026 · South Africa



FIN Value Proposition

Last reviewed: 2026-06-21 **Use for:** current website copy, demos, partner introductions, and sales conversations.

Approved Positioning

FIN is a financial operations platform for South African SMEs, bookkeepers, accountants, and finance teams. It helps turn bank statements, documents, invoices, payroll, VAT, assets, and budgets into controlled accounting workflows, structured ledger records, reports, and audit trails.

FIN is designed for businesses that need better financial records and operating control throughout the year, not only when reporting or tax deadlines arrive.

One-Sentence Proposition

FIN helps South African finance teams turn everyday financial records into reviewable accounting workflows and decision-ready reports.

Short Website Copy

Upload records. Review classifications. Keep the ledger current. Generate the reports your business needs.

FIN brings bookkeeping, documents, payroll, VAT, assets, budgets, and reporting into one company-scoped financial operations platform.

Customer Value

Audience	Problem	FIN value
Business owners	Limited visibility and scattered records	A repeatable workflow from source records to reports
Bookkeepers	Repetitive capture and review across clients	Reusable classification rules, multi-company access, and exports
Accountants and finance teams	Incomplete source records and slow report preparation	Structured ledger records, supporting reports, and audit trail
Integration partners	Need controlled external access	API-client and scoped-entitlement foundation, with enforcement work remaining
Payroll administrators	Need repeatable payroll processing and reviewed statutory outputs	Payroll periods, payslips, postings, settlements, and preparation reports

Differentiators

Bank-Statement And Document Workflows

FIN supports PDF and CSV bank-statement import, document extraction with OCR fallback, transaction classification, reusable mapping rules, correction, and reconciliation. Extracted and classified records remain reviewable.

Secure Document Retention (South African region)

Uploaded source documents — invoice and receipt scans, bank statements, and transaction CSVs — are retained as their original files in a private, encrypted, versioned object store hosted in the South African (Cape Town) region. They are reached only through short-lived, access-checked links and can be downloaded by authorised users from the imported-documents and transaction views. Keeping the source record alongside the resulting transactions supports review, reconciliation, and an audit trail, and supports data-residency expectations for South African businesses. FIN does not make legal or regulatory compliance guarantees.

Ledger-Backed Reporting

Operational records flow into double-entry journals and the general ledger. Customer invoice revenue resolves at line level so one invoice can credit multiple income accounts. FIN produces trial balance, general ledger, income statement, income tax computation, balance sheet, cash flow, cashbook, VAT, payroll, management, AFS, and audit-trail outputs, with PDF preview before selected bundle downloads.

South African Financial Operations

FIN supports South African VAT and payroll workflows, including PAYE, UIF, SDL, VAT 201 reports, and EMP201, EMP501, and IRP5-style preparation outputs. FIN has no current SARS API or eFiling connection; users export or print these reports for manual submission and stakeholder sharing. FIN does not replace professional review.

Controlled Automation

FIN uses reviewable rules, visible journal entries, company-scoped access, correction history, and audit records. Automation reduces repetitive work without hiding the accounting result.

Expandable Commercial Model

FIN tenant access is priced separately from modular add-ons, metered usage, external API licenses, and scoped integration products. Catalogue-only offerings must not be described as purchasable or enforced until they meet the [commercial readiness](#) requirements.

Future Integration Direction

FIN's roadmap includes potential SARS, consent-based bank, CIPC, labour-related, and approved partner integrations. These future connections are intended to reduce duplicated capture and manual handoffs, but they must not be presented as current capabilities. See the [future integrations roadmap](#).

Demonstration Narrative

1. Register on Trial or select a paid tenant plan.
2. Verify the email address and create a company.
3. Configure the fiscal period and company information.
4. Import a bank statement or business document.
5. Review classifications and create a reusable rule.
6. Inspect the resulting journal and ledger records.
7. Generate relevant financial, VAT, payroll, or management reports.
8. Show company-scoped access, audit history, and branded document output.

Trust Language

Use:

- controlled financial workflows;
- reviewable classification and corrections;
- company-scoped access;
- ledger-backed reports;
- SARS-facing preparation support;
- private, encrypted retention of source documents in the South African region (data residency, not a compliance guarantee);
- audit-supporting records and traceability.

Avoid:

- guaranteed compliance;
- automatic SARS submission;
- guaranteed OCR or classification accuracy;
- claims of error-free operation;
- “unlimited” unless a tested limit is genuinely absent;
- unsupported production statistics or customer outcomes.

Commercial References

- [Business model](#)
- [Supported use cases](#)
- [Pricing and licensing](#)
- [Commercial readiness](#)
- [Regulatory reporting boundary](#)
- [Future integrations roadmap](#)
- [Product capability and readiness](#)
- [Customer roles and lifecycle](#)
- [Trust, support and operating boundaries](#)

FIN Manual — Business Owners & Managers

For: owners/managers who configure the company, manage the team and billing, and consume reports.

Status: task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. It is **not** connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling — reports are exported or printed for manual submission or stakeholder sharing.

1. Sign in and choose your workspace

1. Sign in at `https://sthwalo.com/fin`.
2. Pick the **company** and **fiscal period** in the selectors at the top — every screen acts on the selected context.
3. If you're away for ~30 minutes you'll be signed out; a warning appears ~60 seconds before, where you can choose **Stay Logged In**.

2. Create and configure a company

To set up a new company:

1. Open **Company Setup** and create the company.
2. Enter the legal name, **registration and tax/VAT numbers**, and contact details.
3. Add **directors** (used on Annual Financial Statements).
4. Select the **industry** — this offers a starting chart-of-accounts template.
5. Set the **fiscal periods** and **year-end month**.

3. Branding and report profiles

To brand the app and PDFs:

1. In **Company Setup**, open a company's **Company Branding** modal, set the brand colours, and enable the custom theme (the card shows **Custom brand active** vs **Default FIN brand**).
2. Company branding flows to the app UI and is the standard PDF fallback.
3. In **Financial Reports** or **Management Report**, choose or configure a **report profile** to control logo visibility, company/custom/platform-default colours, reusable report packs, and AFS notes.
4. Mark a profile as the **default** for Financial, Management, or AFS PDFs so exports use it automatically.
5. Note: AFS branding is limited to headers/footers so the statement text stays black and readable.

4. Invite your team and assign access

To add a teammate (Account Settings):

1. Open **Account Settings** → **Team Management** and enter the person's email to **invite** them. Inviting adds them to your subscription's shared **seat pool** (ADMIN/SUPER_ADMIN on a paid plan; seat-limited).
2. They receive an email link to create their account.

To grant what they can do per company:

1. In **Account Settings** → **Company Access Assignments**, pick the invited member.
2. Start from a **role preset**, then tick the exact permissions they need **for the selected company**.
3. Access is **per company**, not organisation-wide — repeat per company you want them in.

5. Plans and billing

To manage your subscription:

1. Review your plan and **seats used** in Account Settings.
2. Tenant access plans: **Trial (R0)**, **Starter (R349/mo)**, **Professional (R899/mo)**, **Enterprise (R2,499/mo)**. Modular add-ons, usage charges, and API licences are priced separately.
3. Upgrade/cancel through **PayFast**; activation completes when the payment notification is confirmed.
4. See [Pricing and licensing](#) and the [partner integration guide](#).

6. Dashboards and reports

To review the business:

1. Open the **Admin Dashboard** for the high-level view.
2. Use the **Management Report** for KPIs, VAT, payroll, cash flow, and aged analysis; **preview** the bundle before downloading the final PDF.
3. Use **Financial Reports** for income statement, income-tax computation, balance sheet, cash flow (which ends with cash at the end of the period), bundles, and **AFS** with profile selection.
4. Toggle **Comparative** on a report to get month-by-month columns instead of a single cumulative column.
5. Export to **PDF / CSV / XLSX**; remember these are for your records or **manual** SARS submission.

7. Support

To get help: raise a **support ticket** from the app. For access problems, your ADMIN controls per-company permissions (Section 4).

FIN Manual — Bookkeepers

For: bookkeepers doing day-to-day capture and reconciliation. **Status:** task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. It is not connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling. Payroll and VAT outputs are exported or printed for manual submission or stakeholder sharing.

1. Daily workflow overview

1. Sign in at `https://sthwalo.com/fin`.
2. Select the **company** and **fiscal period** at the top of the screen.
3. Most capture and review tasks live under **Data Management**.

2. Bank statements

To import a bank statement:

1. Go to **Data Management** → **Upload** → **Upload Files**.
2. Drop or browse to upload a **PDF or CSV** statement.
3. Wait for processing (text/OCR extraction), then review the results under **Imported Transactions**.

3. Transaction classification

To classify transactions:

1. Open **Data Management** → **Transaction Classification**.
2. For each line, set the **Debit Account** and **Credit Account**; unclassified rows show **Not classified**.
3. Double-click an account in the account picker to apply a manual classification immediately.
4. To auto-handle recurring items, create a **classification rule** so similar transactions classify automatically next time.
5. In rule creation, double-click an account to select it and create the rule in one action.
6. Use **Data Management** → **Operations** → **View Classification Summary** to confirm nothing is left unclassified.

4. Customer invoices & documents

To raise and download documents (**Data Management** → **Invoices**):

1. Use **Create Invoice** and pick the document type (Sales Invoice, Customer Quotation, Supplier Invoice, Purchase Order, etc.); add line items, discounts, and VAT as required.

2. For customer invoices, leave the line income account as **Auto** unless you need to override it. FIN resolves each line description to an income account and posts grouped revenue credits.
3. Quotations and purchase orders are **non-posting** (document-only).
4. The list separates **Invoices / Quotations / Credit & Debit Notes / Supplier Invoices / Purchase Orders** into tabs; use the per-row **PDF** action to download/print and **Email** to send it.
5. If invoices were edited in bulk, run **Data Management** → **Operations** → **Sync Invoice Journal Entries**.

5. Payroll capture

To process a payroll run:

1. Open **Payroll Management** and confirm employees and the payroll period.
2. Process the run and generate **payslips**.
3. Generate **EMP201**, **EMP501**, and **IRP5-style** reports for accountant review and **manual external submission or stakeholder sharing**. FIN does not submit these reports to SARS.

6. Imported documents (OCR)

To review scanned invoices/receipts: open **Data Management** → **Upload** → **Imported Documents**, check the extracted vendor, VAT No, amount, and totals, and correct any mis-read fields before classifying.

7. Housekeeping

Under **Data Management** → **Operations** (the "Bulk Operations" panel):

- **Reset Classification Setup** — start classification configuration over.
- **Sync Journal Entries / Regenerate All Journal Entries** — fix GL drift after corrections.
- **Reset Period Data** — clear period data when re-importing (use with care; confirm the company and period first).

FIN Manual — Accountants

For: accountants responsible for the full accounting cycle and statutory outputs. **Status:** task steps drafted from the live UI; screenshots still to be added in `images/`.

FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation. It is not connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling. You review, export or print, and manually submit regulatory reports or share them with stakeholders. FIN does not replace professional review.

1. Getting oriented

To set your working context:

1. Sign in at `https://sthwalo.com/fin`.
2. Use the **company selector** and **fiscal period** selector at the top of every screen.
3. Confirm your role: **ADMIN** can manage company setup, users, and billing; **USER** works within granted features. Accountants typically need ADMIN to reach Company Setup and Account Settings.

The left navigation exposes: **Admin Dashboard**, **Company Setup**, **Data Management**, **Financial Reports**, **Management Report**, **VAT Management**, **Payroll Management**, **Asset Register**, **Budget Management**, **Account Settings** (and **System Logs** for admins).

2. Chart of Accounts

- Account types & codes: Assets `1xxx`, Liabilities `2xxx`, Equity `3xxx`, Revenue `4xxx`, Cost of Sales `5xxx`, Expenses `6xxx`.
- Contra accounts: Sales Returns `4080`, Purchases Returns `5080`.

To review the chart of accounts: open **Data Management** → **Chart of Accounts** and review the account list for the selected company and period before classifying transactions.

3. Journals & the General Ledger

To capture a manual journal:

1. Go to **Data Management** → **Adjustment Entry**.
2. Enter the date, description, **Debit Account**, **Credit Account**, and amount; keep the entry balanced.
3. Save. The entry posts to the general ledger for the active company and period.

To keep the ledger consistent after bulk changes: use **Data Management** → **Operations** (the "Bulk Operations" panel):

- **Sync Journal Entries / Sync Invoice Journal Entries** — align documents and the GL.
- **Regenerate All Journal Entries** — rebuild postings after large corrections.

- **View Classification Summary** — confirm coverage before reporting.

To review results: open **Financial Reports** and check **General Ledger** and **Trial Balance**.

Customer invoice revenue is posted at line level. One invoice can credit multiple income accounts; the invoice total debits Trade Debtors, while line net amounts are grouped by resolved income account and credited separately. Lines with no confident match use the fallback income account and are flagged for review rather than silently being treated as correctly resolved.

4. Documents

- Posting documents (invoice, credit/debit note, returns, refund) create accounting effects.
- Quotations and purchase orders are non-posting (document-only).
- Create and manage documents under **Data Management** → **Invoices**; the list separates **Invoices**, **Quotations**, **Credit & Debit Notes**, **Supplier Invoices**, and **Purchase Orders** into tabs. Use the per-row **PDF** action to download/print and **Email** to send to the customer/supplier.

5. VAT

To prepare a VAT return:

1. Open **VAT Management** and confirm the VAT period (monthly / bi-monthly) and configuration.
2. Generate and review the **VAT 201** report with its supporting schedules (PDF).
3. Export or print the VAT 201 for **manual submission to SARS**.
4. Record the external SARS payment, reference, and settlement in FIN.

FIN does not connect to SARS or submit the report through an API.

6. Reports & statements

To produce statutory and review outputs: open **Financial Reports** and generate:

- Trial Balance, Income Statement, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow, Cashbook, General Ledger, Audit Trail.
- **Income Tax Computation** for the taxable-income schedule and manual adjustment placeholders.
- **Annual Financial Statements (AFS)**. Use **Preview AFS** to review the selected AFS profile before download; AFS branding is limited to header/footer chrome while financial text and amounts remain black for readability.
- Use **Management Report** for the KPI / management pack. Use **Preview Bundle** to review the profile-driven PDF bundle before downloading it.
- Export each to **PDF / CSV / XLSX**.

7. Assets & depreciation

To review the asset position: open **Asset Register**.

1. Confirm capitalisation, depreciation method (straight-line / declining balance), and useful life.
2. Generate the year-by-year depreciation schedule PDF (computed from purchase date).
3. Confirm depreciation and disposal postings appear in the ledger.

8. Year-end

1. Reconcile the trial balance and review the audit trail for the period.
2. Confirm asset depreciation and VAT settlements are posted.
3. Close the fiscal period and carry opening balances forward.
4. Produce and sign off the AFS.

Regulatory Reporting Boundary

Last reviewed: 2026-06-06

FIN is not currently connected to a SARS API or SARS eFiling. External SARS automation is a work in progress and must not be described as a current capability.

What FIN Automates Internally

FIN automates internal financial workflows such as payroll and VAT calculations, accounting postings, schedules, controls, settlements recorded in the ledger, and report generation.

FIN can generate SARS-facing outputs including EMP201, EMP501, IRP5-style, and VAT 201 reports. These outputs remain subject to review by the responsible business or finance professional.

What Users Do Externally

Users export or print the relevant reports, manually submit or deliver them to SARS, and share them with other stakeholders when necessary. Users may then record the external payment, submission status, date, or SARS reference in FIN.

An internal status such as `SUBMITTED`, or a SARS reference stored in FIN, records an action that happened outside FIN. It does not mean FIN transmitted data to SARS.

Documentation And Product Language

- Say that FIN prepares or generates SARS-facing reports.
- Say that FIN automates internal calculations, postings, controls, and report generation.
- Say that users export or print reports for manual submission and stakeholder sharing.
- Do not say or imply that FIN connects to SARS, submits returns automatically, guarantees compliance, or replaces professional review.
- Treat future SARS API or eFiling integration as roadmap work until it is implemented, secured, tested, approved, and documented.

See the [future integrations roadmap](#) for SARS and other planned external integration areas.

Trust, Support And Operating Boundaries

Last reviewed: 2026-06-06 **Production deployment:** current implemented trust, support, billing, and operating workflows deployed on 2026-06-06.

This document defines the business promises that the current product can support and the promises that require additional legal, operational, or technical work.

Current Trust Foundations

Area	Current product foundation	Boundary
Company data separation	Production-deployed company memberships, company-scoped routes, tenant-access checks, and targeted row-level-security support	Authorization coverage must continue to be tested across every workflow
Authentication	Production-deployed HttpOnly cookie authentication, refresh-token revocation, logout everywhere, password reset, and owner MFA	Bearer/API-key request authentication is not currently active; customer endpoint/device governance remains necessary
Legal acceptance	Versioned registration acceptance records with source, time, IP address, and user agent	The repository does not establish that every required customer contract or policy is legally complete
Audit support	Audit events, accounting audit trail, correction history, email logs, system logs, and payment events	Audit-supporting records do not constitute an external audit opinion
Data review	Visible classifications, journals, reports, and correction workflows	FIN does not guarantee OCR, classification, accounting, tax, or report accuracy
Data exports	Financial and transaction outputs in supported PDF/CSV/XLSX formats	A complete automated tenant data-portability package is not documented
Account deletion	Admin-operated hard deletion after a six-month inactivity gate and subscription cancellation	Immediate self-service deletion is not implemented
Backup operations	Backup services and administrator backup access exist	Customer-facing recovery objectives and contractual restore guarantees are not published

Support Model

Authenticated users can create support tickets with categories, priorities, comments, and status tracking. FIN administrators can review tickets, comment, and update status.

The Enterprise plan contains a `has_priority_support` feature flag, but differentiated queueing, response times, resolution targets, service credits, support hours, and escalation commitments are not documented as implemented. Do not publish a support SLA until the operational process and contractual terms exist.

Billing And Commercial Boundaries

- PayFast supports current tenant-subscription initiation, payment notification, plan changes, and cancellation workflows.
- Cancellation stops renewal and retains access until the current billing-period end.
- Published prices are monthly ZAR prices.
- Annual billing logic exists in backend abstractions, but no approved annual price or discount is published in the current catalogue.
- Automated refunds, customer tax invoices, failed-payment dunning, usage invoicing, add-on purchase, and billing-grade usage reconciliation are not documented as complete.
- Priority support, API licences, add-ons, and metered usage must not be sold beyond their stated readiness status.

External-Service Boundaries

FIN depends on or may interact with external services only where implemented and configured. A provider mention does not create a guarantee of availability, approval, or successful delivery.

External area	Current position
PayFast	Production-deployed tenant-subscription payment provider workflow
Business-document and verification email	Production-deployed email workflows; successful external delivery depends on configured mail services and recipient systems
SARS and eFiling	No connection; reviewed reports are submitted manually
Bank feeds	No direct feed; supported statements are imported from files
CIPC and labour-related services	No connection; roadmap only
Integration partners	API-client and entitlement foundation exists; enforcement and usage coverage remain incomplete

Claims Requiring Separate Approval

The following require legal, operational, security, and product approval before publication:

- uptime, availability, recovery-time, or recovery-point guarantees;
- support response or resolution SLAs;
- guaranteed compliance, accuracy, savings, or business outcomes;
- automated regulatory submission or provider connectivity;
- certifications, endorsements, accreditations, or regulator approval;
- complete data portability, retention, deletion, or residency guarantees;
- automatic refunds, tax invoicing, or billing reconciliation;
- unlimited usage or capacity.

Responsible Positioning

FIN may be described as a controlled, company-scoped financial operations platform with reviewable workflows, ledger-backed reports, audit-supporting records, and current subscription management. It must

not be positioned as a substitute for professional review or as providing unimplemented contractual guarantees.